

Vacancy & vitality scan

What this tool produces · *A spatialized inventory of empty ground-floor units and underutilized lots, paired with a strategic assessment of their potential for short-term reactivation.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Economic

Spatial

Social / User

Preparing the workshop · *Vacancy & vitality scan*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Refusing the inevitability of closed shutters and dark streets; treating urban emptiness not as a failure, but as a blank canvas awaiting the creativity of the community.

Evidence we produce

A spatialized inventory of empty ground-floor units and underutilized lots, paired with a strategic assessment of their potential for short-term reactivation.

Duration & Material

Duration · 3 to 6 weeks of field surveying and matchmaking

Material · Cadastral maps, vacancy tracking spreadsheets, community consultation guides

Reference case

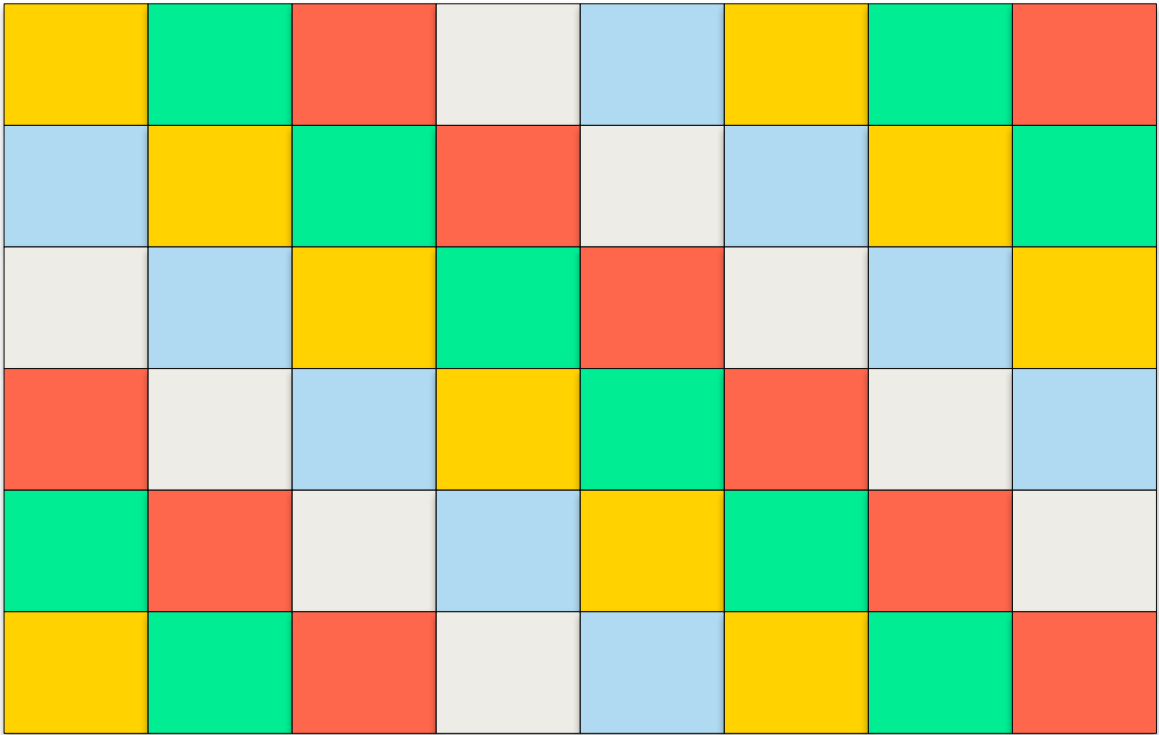
The Festival of Empty Shops in Budapest (Hungary) successfully opened long-vacant ground-level spaces for dozens of local merchants. By using temporary use strategies, these pop-up stores attracted hundreds of participants, instantly revitalizing dismal streets and fostering local prosperity and placemaking.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Vacancy heatmap × vitality bars

Duration
3 to 6 weeks of field surveying and
matchmaking

Vacancy heatmap



Vitality dimensions

Foot-traffic



Active frontages



Commerce mix



Events / culture



Daytime / nightlife mix



Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.